■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, August 03, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (3 stories)

■ *Spider-Man breaks biggest opening weekend record in North America*

The Angle: *Spider-Man just dethroned Avengers: Endgame for the largest opening weekend ever in the US and Canada—a massive flex for Sony and a sign the superhero formula is still box-office gold, even in a crowded streaming world.*

- **Spider-Man: Brand New Day** pulled in **$360 million US** in its opening weekend across US and Canada theatres
- The film broke the previous record held by **Avengers: Endgame**
- Sony Pictures announced the achievement on Monday

The Hot Take

- Is the superhero bubble finally bursting, or did Spider-Man just prove these movies will always print money—and what does that mean for the rest of Hollywood?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/spider-man-brand-new-day-opening-weekend-9.7294989?cmp=rss

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■■ *Border wall construction halted over New Mexico water crisis*

The Angle: *The Trump administration just pumped the brakes on border wall drilling in drought-stricken New Mexico after ranchers sounded the alarm—groundwater needed for concrete could dry up what little water livestock have left. It's a collision between federal infrastructure and a genuine environmental crisis.*

- **Trump administration** ordered construction crews to **stop drilling wells** for border wall work
- The wells were being used to pump **groundwater needed to make concrete**
- **Ranchers** raised concerns that pumping would threaten **livestock water supplies** in drought-stricken New Mexico
- The order came after public pressure over competing water demands in a region already facing severe drought stress

The Conflict Check

- When federal projects clash with local survival—who wins, and should they?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/world-news/contractors-building-border-wall-ordered-to-stop-drilling-wells-in-drought-stricken-new-mexico/

■■ *Lindsey Graham's sister jumps into heated South Carolina Senate race*

The Angle: *Darline Graham, the late senator's sister, just threw her hat in the ring to replace Lindsey Graham in one of the GOP's safest seats—and she's already making bold moves in the primary, pledging Trump loyalty and filibuster reform. This is a genuine test of whether family name alone can carry a Senate bid in a crowded field.*

- **Darline Graham** announced her candidacy just **two weeks** after her brother **Senator Lindsey Graham** died of **an aortic rupture last month**
- She's running in the **South Carolina Senate primary** to succeed one of the **most influential GOP senators in history**
- At her debut debate, she pledged to **nuke the filibuster** and stand **'100% behind' Trump**

The Family Legacy Question

- Does Lindsey Graham's name and conservative playbook guarantee his sister a seat, or does South Carolina want to pick their own person for this job?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/us-news/darline-graham-pledges-to-nuke-the-filibuster-stand-100-behind-trump-in-south-carolina-senate-primary-debate/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Hundreds of migrant kids stranded after deadly Mediterranean crossing*

The Angle: *Over 800 unaccompanied minors are now stuck in Spain's Ceuta after a massive surge of migrants crossed from Morocco—some didn't make it. This is a humanitarian crisis unfolding in real time with major implications for European border policy.*

- **More than 800 minors** are stranded in Ceuta after the crossing, separated from families
- A teenage girl's **younger brother drowned** in the Mediterranean during the surge; their mother disappeared in the chaos
- **Tens of thousands of people** surged through the breakwater trying to leave Morocco in a single collective push
- This happened **four days ago** and the minors now face an uncertain future with no clear next steps

The Moral Question

- What's Spain's responsibility to these kids—and what should happen to them now that they're there?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/children-stranded-spain-morocco-ceuta-crossing-9.7295276?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Trendy LA bar with secret entrance busted for vermin nightmare*

The Angle: *A swanky Hollywood hotspot known for its speakeasy vibes just got shut down by health inspectors over a serious pest problem—a reminder that even the most exclusive venues aren't immune to the basics. It's the kind of "behind-the-velvet-rope" reality check that makes for great watercooler talk.*

- **Good Times at Davey Wayne's** in Los Angeles was temporarily closed due to health code violations
- The violation centered on a **vermin infestation** discovered during inspection
- The bar is known for its **secret entrance** and hidden speakeasy-style atmosphere

The Reality Check

- Ever been to a place so exclusive you felt like you were breaking rules just walking in—and then found out they couldn't even handle basic pest control? What's the fanciest spot you've been to that's let you down?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/lifestyle/good-times-at-davey-waynes-forced-to-close-due-to-vermin-infestation/

Backup options:

■ *Women want fit partners—but won't approach them*

The Angle: *A new survey flips the script on dating stereotypes: women care more about fitness in a partner than men do, yet they're way more anxious about actually making the first move. It's a confidence gap that says a lot about modern dating dynamics.*

- **Women are more likely than men to want a fitter partner**, according to the survey
- Despite this preference, **women report significantly higher anxiety about dating fit partners** compared to men

- The gap highlights a disconnect between what women *say* they want and what they're willing to pursue

The Double Standard

- Do you want different things than you're brave enough to actually go after—and is that a dating problem or a confidence problem?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Confession Round** - Open the phone lines -> Ask listeners: 'What's the mismatch between who you'd *like* to date and who you'd actually have the confidence to approach?' Take 2–3 calls.
- **Step 2: Host Head-to-Head** - Quick back-and-forth -> Hosts debate: Is this a female-only anxiety thing, or do men feel it too—just in different ways? (Vulnerability vs. rejection fear, etc.)
- **Step 3: The Reframe** - Land the takeaway -> Talk about what changes this dynamic: Does lowering the bar help, or does confidence itself become the real attractor?

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/life/sex-files/dating-fitness-and-closing-the-confidence-gap

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■■ *Trailblazer Kay Granger, Texas GOP pioneer, dies at 83*

The Angle: *Kay Granger broke ground as the first Republican woman from Texas ever elected to Congress and spent nearly three decades wielding real power—she chaired the House Appropriations Committee, one of Congress's most influential posts. Her death marks the end of a historic career and raises questions about women's representation in Texas Republican politics.*

- **Kay Granger** was the **first Republican woman from Texas** ever elected to the U.S. House of Representatives, winning her seat in **1996**.
- She chaired the **House Appropriations Committee**, one of the most powerful committees in Congress, controlling billions in federal spending.
- She did not seek reelection in **2024** and experienced **worsening health challenges in her final months in Congress**, according to her office.

The Legacy Check

- How many listeners actually know the names of women who've wielded real power behind the scenes in Congress—and why don't we talk about them as much as we do the headline-makers?

Politico (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.politico.com/news/2026/08/02/kay-granger-first-republican-woman-texas-house-dies-at-age-83-01022042

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/3 this month; TECH TALK 0/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *'House of the Dragon': Gayle Rankin on That 'F — ed Up' Aemond-Alys-Alicent Scene, 'Unbearable' Family Dinner and Dragon Egg Plans - Variety*

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Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/house-of-the-dragon-aemond-alys-rivers-alicent-sex-eggs-1236824981/

■ *Christopher Nolan: There Is a 'Fundamental Flaw' With Film Criticism - Variety*

The Angle: *Christopher Nolan: There Is a 'Fundamental Flaw' With Film Criticism - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/christopher-nolan-flaw-film-criticism-the-odyssey-1236826067/

■ *Stephen Baldwin finally reveals why he ditched Hollywood: 'I didn't want to be Tom Cruise' - Page Six*

The Angle: *Stephen Baldwin finally reveals why he ditched Hollywood: 'I didn't want to be Tom Cruise' - Page Six*

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/08/02/celebrity-news/stephen-baldwin-finally-reveals-why-he-ditched-hollywood/

■ *More belugas from Marineland in Niagara Falls, Ont., head to new home in U.S.*

The Angle: *More belugas from Marineland in Niagara Falls, Ont., head to new home in U.S.*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/hamilton/marineland-belugas-head-to-u-s-9.7295415?cmp=rss

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■ *Washington wildfire evacuees return to total loss*

The Angle: *Massive wildfires tore through eastern Washington over the weekend, leaving entire neighborhoods reduced to ash and rubble. Residents are now returning to find their homes—and in some cases, entire communities—completely leveled, with only chimneys standing as reminders of what was there.*

- Wildfires erupted across **eastern Washington state over the weekend**
- Entire neighborhoods have been **leveled**, with only **chimneys left standing** in some cases
- Homes are buried under **charred debris**, leaving residents to sift through what remains

The Hard Questions

- Have you or someone you know dealt with losing a home to disaster—and what's the first thing you'd do if you had to start over?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/washington-state-wildfire-evacuees-9.7295264?cmp=rss

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■ *MLS launches investigation into antisemitic abuse at Montreal match*

The Angle: *Major League Soccer is cracking down after fans at a Saturday game in Montreal allegedly hurled antisemitic slurs at an opposing player—part of a larger reckoning in North American sports over fan behavior and hate speech in stadiums.*

- **MLS is investigating reports of antisemitic and discriminatory language** directed at a player during a **CF Montreal home game Saturday** at **Saputo Stadium**
- The incident comes as sports leagues increasingly face pressure to address fan misconduct and hate speech at live events
- CF Montreal and opposing teams have not yet publicly identified the targeted player or specific details of the abuse

The Real Talk Moment

- How much responsibility do sports organizations have to police their own fan bases, and what's the actual consequence that would change behavior?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/cf-montreal-fans-discrimination-9.7295063?cmp=rss

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■ *Meet Saskatchewan's threatened 'butcher bird' that impales its prey*

The Angle: *Meet Saskatchewan's threatened 'butcher bird' that impales its prey*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/saskatchewan/shrike-threatened-birds-9.7289364?cmp=rss

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■ *Blue Jays overcome Vladimir Guerrero Jr.'s hitting woes to beat red-hot Houston Astros*

The Angle: *Blue Jays overcome Vladimir Guerrero Jr.'s hitting woes to beat red-hot Houston Astros*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/toronto-blue-jays/blue-jays-overcome-vladimir-guerrero-jr-s-hitting-woes-to-beat-red-hot-houston-astros

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■ *Blue Jays swing for the fences and mend others in torrid MLB trade deadline remake — was it enough?*

The Angle: *Blue Jays swing for the fences and mend others in torrid MLB trade deadline remake — was it enough?*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/toronto-blue-jays/blue-jays-swing-for-the-fences-and-mend-others-in-torrid-mlb-trade-deadline-remake-was-it-enough

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■ *Yankees call up George Lombard Jr., send down Anthony Volpe in telling move after trade deadline*

The Angle: *Yankees call up George Lombard Jr., send down Anthony Volpe in telling move after trade deadline*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/sports/yankees-calling-up-top-prospect-george-lombard-jr-in-major-boost-after-trade-deadline/

■ *Fury as major freeway ramp closed in aid of $114M wildlife crossing*

The Angle: *Fury as major freeway ramp closed in aid of $114M wildlife crossing*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/us-news/101-freeway-ramp-closed-for-construction-of-114m-wildlife-crossing/

■ *AJ Preller defends Padres' prospect purge at trade deadline: 'We don't apologize'*

The Angle: *AJ Preller defends Padres' prospect purge at trade deadline: 'We don't apologize'*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/sports/aj-preller-defends-padres-prospect-purge-at-trade-deadline-we-dont-apologize/

■ *Hasan Piker marvels at 'white dude bros' supporting far-left candidate Abdul El-Sayed on eve of Michigan Senate primary*

The Angle: *Hasan Piker marvels at 'white dude bros' supporting far-left candidate Abdul El-Sayed on eve of Michigan Senate primary*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/08/03/us-news/abdul-el-sayed-stumps-with-hasan-piker-on-primary-eve-who-marvels-over-white-dude-bros-supporting-him/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 5 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Firefighters rescue man from s–tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 27 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars' favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Google Images Is Trying to Be… Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)
- "'Goodbye, Lara' Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You'll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: 'Your love will forever be woven into who we are'" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)
- "'Scrubs' Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I'm Buying During Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "'La La Land' 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling's Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "'Harry Potter' Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature 'Sorcerer's Stone' 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC's 'Happy's Place'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom's Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here's How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band's 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said 'Absolutely No Goddamn AI' in 'Pan's Labyrinth' 3D Re-Release: 'We're Protecting a Lineage of Art'" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah's 'favorites' at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from 'ultra-flattering' pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)

- "'Star Trek: Starfleet Academy' Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror' Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of 'Jesus Christ Superstar' After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)
- "'Sunday in the Park with George' Producers Confirm Summer 2027 Show Will Go On 'As Planned' After Ariana Grande Exits" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-03)
- "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-08-03)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Nordstrom Anniversary Sale Ends Soon — 27 Steals From Hollywood's Most-Loved Labels"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 15 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-08-03 11:35 PM